Silver

Moon · coolness · reflection

Silver can be a spoon from grandmother, a mirror, the moon over a roof, a new phone or hair that has decided to stop being dyed. One time it is cool and elegant. Another time it reminds you of how someone looks at you and says nothing. What do you see in it and what is reflected in it?

This page does not tell you what silver means. **It shows it to you from several sides**. How it is mixed, how you paint with it, where its reputation comes from, how it is read in different cultures and **what it can awaken in us**.

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How to mix the colour and its shades

Silver is not one colour from a tube. It is an impression of metallic shine that changes with the light and the angle of view. A silver paint with metallic particles, silver leaf and a grey with a bit of white behave differently. On a screen it can hardly be shown.

Silver cannot be mixed so that it gleams. Grey with a drop of blue and a tip of white gives a silver **shade**, not a silver **shine**. Shine comes from metallic pigments, silver leaf or from a ground that reflects light.

What to prepare



White

The basis for light silver tones.



Black

Really just a touch, for steel.



Blue

For a cool tint.



Brown

A trace for a warmer, older silver.



Grey

A ready-made neutral grey as a base.



Metallic silver paint

A ready-made paint with metallic particles for real shine.

A shade, or a shine?

Silver is the colour of light and reflection. On paper you will see how it changes when you move your head. On a screen even the best silver is only a shade.

So try silver paint for crafts on paper and look at it from several directions. **Only then decide whether a grey shade is enough for you or whether you want metal.**

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What the additions do



Blue

Shifts it to a cool, moonlike silver.





Brown

Shifts it to a warmer one, like an old piece of cutlery.





Ochre

Shifts it to champagne and light gold. Just the tip.





Violet

Shifts it to a lavender silver.





Green

Shifts it to a sage, patinated one.





White

Lightens it to pearly and misty.



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Ten silvers to try

A part can be a drop or an equally large heap of paint. The strength of pigments differs, so **take the proportions as a starting point for experimenting**. Shine is added only by metallic paint.

Basic silver



Grey and white. A shade without shine.

Steel



Grey and a trace of black and blue. Firm and cool.

Pearl



White and a tip of grey. Delicate and light.

Mirror



White, grey and a trace of blue. Clean and cold.

Oxidised



Grey, black and a trace of brown. Dark and matt.

Warm silver



Grey, white and a trace of brown. Soft and earthy.

Moon



White, blue and grey. Cool and dreamy.

Sage



Grey, white and a trace of green. Patinated.

Lavender



White, violet and grey. Delicate and airy.

Metallic



A ready-made metallic paint and a tip of black. Shine and depth.

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Rainbow – the chakra system

Silver does not have **a stripe of its own** in the rainbow. It is an impression, not a wavelength. We mostly interpret it as a cooler and lighter counterpart of grey. In some current approaches it accompanies the **crown chakra** and the third eye, sometimes with the theme of the moon and intuition. The assignments differ.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions



Red · root
Support, safety, presence. Ask yourself. What can I lean on?



Orange · sacral
Experiencing, pleasure, sensuality. Ask yourself. What does me good?



Yellow · solar plexus
Self-worth, will, decision-making. Ask yourself. What do I want to choose for myself?



Green · heart
Closeness, kindness, relationships. Ask yourself. Where can I be open and still stay with myself?



Blue · throat
Voice, expression, communication. Ask yourself. What do I need to say?



Indigo · third eye
Inner vision, intuition, discernment. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?



Violet · crown
Transcendence, meaning, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me a wider sense of meaning?



Silver · next to indigo and the crown
Reflection and perspective. Ask yourself. What do I see in this reflection, and what do only others see?

Chakras and silver

Chakras come from the Indian yoga and tantric tradition. The sixth chakra Ajna is linked with indigo and the seventh Sahasrara with violet or light. Silver is added to them only in modern interpretations, sometimes with the moon, perspective and intuition.

That does not mean silver is the colour of people who see more. And it need not mean that whoever wears it is escaping from the world. Silver can just be a beautiful colour that suits you.

When silver does you good. You feel light, clean and modern in it. A silver piece of jewellery, hair or fabric gives you calm without explaining.

When silver does not do you good. It feels cold, aloof or like a surface from which everything bounces off. These are not proofs of the state of a chakra. It is information about your relationship to distance.

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A reflection that needs no audience

- **Put it beside**
  A silver paper or piece of jewellery next to a colour that attracts you. Notice them for a while without looking for the right meaning.
- **Take it in your hand**
  A spoon, a coin or a stone. Ask what you let reflect today and what you take in.
- **Put it on**
  One silver detail on simple clothing. A chain, earrings or a button.
- **Put it in a room**
  A mirror or candlestick. A silver frame does not behave like a silver wall.
- **Paint it**
  One silver line on dark paper. Notice the hand, the pressure and whether you want to go on.
- **Look at the moon**
  In the evening sky or on water. Silver can exist even without paint, simply in the light.

When there is already too much silver

Distance can be useful, but it can also become a wall. Perhaps everything reflects off you and nothing touches you. **You do not need more silver.** You need to invite warm colours that will take something in.

- **With brown**
  Do I have support and warmth beneath the reflection?
- **With pink**
  Is there room for tenderness?
- **With gold**
  Can I accept celebration too?
- **With black**
  Do I see a clear contrast that helps me tell things apart?

This is inspiration from tradition, not treatment. It is not about measuring chakras. You notice how the relationship of colours affects you and what theme it reminds you of.

Picture it with an example

Next to silver other colours calm down. A dark blue feels deep, black elegant, pink fresh. **These are possibilities of personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a colour combination.

How to use this map

It is a way to sort out the themes you are living through. Do you add the colour because you are missing warmth, or do you not need it because calm is enough for you? **You choose the meaning.** Both options can be fine.

In the classical seven-colour map silver has no eighth place.

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Free painting – intuition

When we paint freely, with no goal and no effort to make a pretty picture, we often reach for silver when we want **a soft shine**, or when we need **a little distance**. We do not always know why, though. Sometimes we know exactly, other times not at all. Both are fine.

What may be hiding behind a silver stroke

The same silver line on paper can mean **something completely different every time**, depending on what is going on in us at the moment. That is why there is no point in reading a painting like a test with a single correct answer.

Calm.

Soft silver areas and broad strokes. A colour that calms.

Night.

Silver on a dark ground. The moon, water, a gleam.

Distance.

A thin line that separates. Silence between two things.

Elegance.

A delicate, clean stroke. Pleasure in the fact that there is order.

Sadness.

A muted silver over livelier places. Something that cannot yet be shown.

Joy in shine.

The pure taste of metal and light. No hidden meaning.

Silver in a painting. Can it express what is happening inside?

Yes, **it can**, but **it does not have to**. A silver stroke is not automatically a message about coldness or aloofness. It can mean calm, the moon, elegance, distance and simple joy in shine. The amount of silver alone does not determine your state. That holds even when a child uses it.

While working you do not have to decide what exactly it means. Notice the hand, the pressure and whether you want to go on. Meaning comes only in connection with **your experience**.

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I want it on the canvas, but I don't dare put it on myself

A painting and a dress ask two completely different things of you. Silver in a painting can be quiet and beautiful, and still you do not feel like wearing a silver coat. Or the other way round. A silver mirror and silver earrings do not exclude each other.

Imagine the same silver on three women. On a woman with grey hair, on a singer and on a teenage girl. With the first you say “natural”, with the second “stage”, with the third “what is going on?”. **The colour has not changed. Your expectations have.**

A silver wardrobe is not automatically a sign of coldness or distance. First of all it is the wardrobe of a particular woman.

When silver takes over the space

First let the hand work. **Silver does not have to cover anything.** If you are afraid it will cool everything, try it first on a small paper or hold a silver cut-out against the painting. You will see the change without having to make it permanent right away.

Three things worth noticing

- **SHAPE**

  A line, an area, or glitter?

  A thin silver line can connect or separate something. A large area can create calm as well as coolness. While working you do not have to decide what exactly it means. Only later can you ask whether the stroke meant relief, distance or just pleasure in shine.

- **WEIGHT**

  Light, or cold?

  If the silver feels pleasantly light, leave it alone for a while and watch its shape. If an area is too cold, add a warm accent or a matt layer. If everything is glossy, add a difference of surface, direction of strokes or lightness.

- **COURAGE**

  You do not have to fill the whole surface at once

  Courage in painting does not mean you have to intervene in everything at once. If you want a gentle accent, try one line or a small circle. If you keep covering the previous layers, notice the feeling of covering itself. The interpretation can wait.

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What to take from the picture

It does not matter how the silver stroke looks. What matters is what you feel while making it and what is happening in your life at that moment. **Two identical paintings can have a completely different meaning.** One came from a feeling of calm, the other after a day when you wanted to withdraw. That is why you will not find a dictionary here, but **questions**.

A picture can speak even after time

Perhaps later you will connect the painting with a period when you needed to calm down. Perhaps with a decision that gave you perspective. Or you will keep seeing in it mainly a beautiful shine. In self-reflection inspired by art therapy what counts is the connection of the painting, your experience and a specific period of life. Silver by itself does not know your story.

Answers often do not come right away

Sometimes you look at what you have painted and it tells you nothing. In a week, a month or a year, though, it may suddenly dawn on you. That is fine. **The painting will wait until you are ready to understand it.**

If very strong or painful feelings appear while painting, do not stay alone with them. Talk about them with someone close or with a therapist. This page does not replace professional care.

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Associations and stories

Our associations

Associations are the connections that form between us and a colour. We are not born with a ready-made list “silver = this”, and yet they tend to be surprisingly similar. They are usually made up of three layers: **the body**, **culture** and **what we have lived through ourselves**.

From the body

Silver is the colour of **the moon, water and mist**. The eye catches it by the reflection that changes when you move. That helps explain why silver can have a relationship to coolness and to a feeling of distance.

From culture

In most of the world silver is linked with **the moon, purity and second place**. Coins, cutlery, medals, mirrors. At the same time it can mean betrayal and cold distance. In the chapter on cultures we will look at this in more detail.

From what you have lived

Grandmother's spoons, a silver chain from a godmother, a first silver ring. These memories decide the most. **Two women can look at the same silver** and one feels calm, the other distance.

When you know where your associations come from, it is easier to tell what is actually “silver” and what is your story about it. You can ask yourself now. **What does silver connect with first for me and where do I know that from?**

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Stories

Silver has several stories worth untangling. They show where the colour ends and where begins what people make of it.

The silver bullet

In folklore silver is linked with protection against supernatural beings. Some authors connect the silver bullet against werewolves with the Beast of Gévaudan, which the hunter Jean Chastel was supposed to have killed in **1767**. According to one review, the story of silver bullets made from melted-down medals with the Virgin Mary is a distortion mainly from Henri Pourrat's novel of 1946. Silver as the standard weapon against werewolves was made only by the 1941 film The Wolf Man.

Today the phrase silver bullet means a simple solution to a hard problem. Silver here is not a metal. It is **a story about how much we want a simple recipe**.

The mirror

Glass mirrors appear from the first century and for centuries were small and uneven. In the Renaissance a mirror of tin and mercury arose, which Venice long held. In **1835** the German chemist Justus von Liebig developed a procedure in which a thin layer of silver is chemically applied to glass. The method made it possible to produce mirrors on a large scale.

Silver in a mirror does not reflect colour but light. It seemingly disappears itself and shows you. Silver is **a metal that hides in order to show something else**.

Photography from silver

In **1839** the daguerreotype was publicly announced. A silvered copper plate was polished to a mirror, exposed to iodine vapours and after exposure the image was developed with mercury vapours. The result is a unique image on a mirror surface, which looks like a positive or a negative depending on the angle of view.

For a long time afterwards photography rested on the sensitivity of silver halides. Silver thus carries light and memory at once. Silver here is not coldness. It is **a place where light was written down**.

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Emotions and feelings

The same silver can awaken **calm** in one of us and **distance** in another, sometimes even both in one day. There is no single fixed effect. It depends on our body, experience, culture and situation.

Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that can appear even before you realise them.

Calm

A feeling that **it is quiet** and nothing presses.

And why?

Moonlight, smooth water, morning mist. Silver can link with moments when nothing needs sorting out.

Ask yourself

"When did I last have nothing I had to do?"

Distance

A feeling that you can **keep your space**.

And why?

A mirror shows but does not touch. Distance is often needed when there has been a lot. What is interesting is to notice whether it serves you, or separates you from people.

And what if I asked you now?

"When is distance a relief and when a wall?"

Elegance

A feeling that **everything is in its place**.

And why?

Clean cutlery, a straight line, delicate jewellery. Silver can give an impression of order and taste. Sometimes, though, beneath it is the tiredness of keeping it up.

And try answering now

"What do I enjoy about elegance and what only tires me?"

Sadness

A feeling that **everything is muted**.

And why?

A grey morning, a shine that does not warm. Silver can recall moments when something is missing. It does not show the size of the pain, though.

And now one question for you

"What am I missing and who could I tell?"

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Feelings and experience

Deeper and slower states that settle in us. You often recognise them only after a while.

Mirroring

A feeling that **you see yourself through other people's eyes**.

And why?

A silver surface shows you yourself. Sometimes that helps and sometimes it turns into constant comparing.

Ask yourself

"Whose eyes do I see when I look at myself?"

Intuition

A feeling that **you know, even though you do not know why**.

And why?

The moon, night, silence. Silver is often linked with quiet knowing. Intuition is neither a miracle nor a certainty. Check it against life.

And what if I asked you now?

"What does my hunch tell me and what would my experience say?"

Fear of coldness

A feeling that in another colour **you would be too warm**.

And why?

When you want silver but are afraid of seeming aloof, it is precisely this worry that deserves attention. If you love silver, though, you do not have to re-educate yourself.

And try answering now

"Do I choose silver because I love it, or because I am afraid of being close?"

Purity

A feeling that **it is clean and light**.

And why?

Polished silver, water, ice. Silver gives an impression of cleanliness that has to be maintained, though. Cleanliness can be relief as well as pressure.

And now one question for you

"What would I give myself today if everything did not have to be clean?"

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My silver is not the same as your silver

The colour itself **experiences nothing**. We experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), the **experience** sticks to it. The colour then becomes a **shortcut**. That is why **your own reaction** is the most important.

- **Silver cutlery**
  For one celebration, for another the need to wash up.
- **Silver hair**
  For one dignity, for another ageing.
- **A silver moon**
  For one calm, for another loneliness.
- **A silver car**
  For one practicality, for another boredom.
- **A silver medal**
  For one success, for another second place.

Why does it attract me right now?

Perhaps you need a little distance that covers nothing up. Or its clean and modern form suits you. **A liking for silver has no single hidden meaning.**

Does it really suit?

Silver jewellery looks different on different skin tones and in different light. A cool skin undertone may match it, but that is not a rule. Try two shades by your face in daylight and notice the whole impression, not just whether your skin glows.

When to take silver away

When a particular whole weighs on you, feels cold or keeps reminding you of expectations you do not want to meet. Start with one change. A warmer companion, a matt surface, a smaller area. **Silver can be your choice. It does not have to be your duty.**

Ask yourself

“Which sentence about silver is loudest in me? Whose is it actually?”

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Silver in cultures and traditions

Silver is a colour that people long thought was “obvious”. Purity, the moon, second place. Behind its reputation, though, are **more stories about trade, faith and craft than about the colour itself**. Let us look at a few places and read them well.

This chapter therefore shows **two levels**. First, how silver is read in different **cultures**, and then how **traditional systems** look at it, using it as an image, not as a guide. What is verified history and what a later interpretation, I say in each part.

Silver in different cultures

Czechia

Silver began to be mined in Kutná Hora in 1260 and around 1300 King Wenceslas II issued the mining code Ius regale montanorum. Soon afterwards the main mint of the Czech lands arose there, where the Prague groschen were struck. The Italian Court served as the royal mint from 1300 to 1727.

From a town that grew from a hill of silver into the second most important in the kingdom.

Silver here is **a gift of the land that turned into power**.

Bolivia

Potosí arose in 1545 as a mining settlement and Cerro Rico supplied a large part of the silver that financed the Spanish Empire. The mint struck pieces of eight there. Around 1600 it was the second largest city in the world.

From a mountain that shone so that its name became a byword for wealth.

Silver here is **a metal that moved the world**.

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France

In 1839 the daguerreotype was publicly announced. A copper plate coated with silver was polished to a mirror, exposed to iodine vapours and after exposure the image was developed with mercury vapours. The result was a unique image on a mirror surface.

From Paris, where light was first written into silver.

Silver here is **memory stored in metal**.

Germany

In 1835 the chemist Justus von Liebig developed a procedure in which a thin layer of silver is chemically applied to glass. Many more mirrors could thus be produced at a much lower price.

From a laboratory from which the mirror reached every home.

Silver here is **a reflection that became a matter of course**.

Silver in traditional systems

Every tradition looks at silver **a little differently**, but all take it seriously. It is an old symbolic language and a source of inspiration, not a healing guide.

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Traditional Chinese medicine

In the traditional system of five elements white is linked with metal, autumn, the lungs, the large intestine and grief. Silver is a metal, so in the tradition it is often read next to white. That is my own reflection, not a classical table.

How it relates to the colour silver. For our story the image can carry the thought of inhaling and exhaling, receiving and letting go. A silver piece of jewellery or light has nothing to arrange. It can merely accompany a moment when you allow yourself to be without duties. **Colour does not replace rest.**

And what if I asked you now?

“What do I no longer want to hold and what do I need to keep?”

Autumn and purity

Autumn in the tradition belongs to metal and to letting go. Silver can accompany tidying up, putting aside a duty or an empty shelf. The benefit is clarity, not cleansing.

Winter is not the end

Calm can restore strength. If it turns into a long closing-off in which you do not feel well, add a warm accent. **You do not have to choose one position for ever.**

Traditional Chinese medicine uses the elements as an image. It is not a diagnosis and does not replace a doctor.

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Ayurveda

Ayurveda is an old Indian teaching about health. It describes a person by three types of "energy", the so-called doshas. Vata (air, restlessness), pitta (fire, intensity) and kapha (earth and water, heaviness). Colours are not assigned to the doshas uniformly in the classical texts, so here you read **modern interpretations**, not an old table.

How it relates to the colour silver. In Ayurveda-inspired work we can ask about coolness, shine and heaviness. Silver does not give the same experience in every material. A matt silver fabric and a glossy metal are rather different worlds.

Pitta

This is how a woman is described who is purposeful, quick and thorough, and flares up easily. A cool silver can give a calming impression. Too sharp a shine, though, can irritate.

- **Matt and soft**
  Cooling and calm.
- **Beware of shine**
  A sharp glitter can be an extra stimulus.

Vata

This is how a woman is described who is imaginative and quick, but restless, and is often cold. A cold silver can strengthen the feeling of chill. Add a warm fabric and light. **It is best to notice how you really feel in it.**

- **Warm companion**
  Wool, wood, a candle.
- **Evening**
  Soft light instead of harsh.

Kapha

This is how a woman is described who is calm, steady and patient, but who easily becomes heavy. Silver can add lightness, but large cool areas weigh a space down. **Add movement and colour to them.**

- **A light accent**
  Jewellery, a lamp, a mirror.
- **Add colour**
  Green or pink as a counterbalance.

We will therefore not make silver a universal ban or a remedy for a particular dosha. More interesting is whether a particular form brings you comfort or weighs on you.

An online test will not reliably determine your dosha. If you are more interested, consult a qualified Ayurvedic practitioner. It is not treatment.

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A Jungian view

Carl Gustav Jung, the Swiss psychiatrist, understood colours as symbols that have two layers. A personal one (what we have experienced with the colour) and one shared by all people (images that repeat across ages and cultures).

Jung did not describe silver as a separate colour. What I write next is my own reflection in the spirit of his thought, not his statement. In alchemy silver is linked with the Moon and gold with the Sun, and Jung read alchemy as an image of inner transformation. In such a reading silver can mean **the softer, quieter pole of inner light**.

How it relates to the colour silver. In symbolic language you can read silver as **the colour of reflection and perspective**. When you think about it, ask what in it is yours and what belongs to the expectations of others.

What you can take from it. Jung did not want colours to be made into a dictionary. **We always ask what it means for you.** The same silver can be a support for one woman and pressure for another. Jung's ideas about colours are a symbolic framework, not verified science.

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Feng shui

Feng shui is the Chinese art of arranging a space so that it is good to live in. In feng shui interpretations silver and metallic colours are often assigned to the element of metal. Schools differ in the assignment, so take it as one of the possibilities.

Silver is like a mirror

A little adds shine to a space, a whole room turns it into a cold hall. Mirrors and silver work when there is room to rest in them.

Simple tips

- **Start small**
  A silver frame, candlestick or lamp. A silver frame does not behave like a silver wall.
- **Choose matt**
  A matt silver feels quieter than a glossy one.
- **Give it warmth**
  Wood, linen, a candle and warm light soften it.
- **Watch the mirrors**
  A mirror opposite the bed or the door often creates a feeling of restlessness. Try another place.
- **Try it in daylight**
  See how it looks in the morning and in the evening.
- **Try textiles first**
  Before you repaint a wall, try a cushion or a larger sample.

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What people say and what holds true

MYTH Silver goes black because it is dirty.

TRUTH Silver reacts with a small amount of sulphur in the air and forms a dark coating. That is normal and it can be polished away.

MYTH Silver is cold and impersonal.

TRUTH It depends on the surface. Brushed or matt silver next to wood and linen feels softer than shine and glass.

MYTH Gold and silver must not be mixed.

TRUTH That is an older rule. Today they are mixed, just watch the proportion and unify the surfaces.

What silver works well with

- **White**
  A clean and light impression. Watch that it is not sterile.
- **Dark blue**
  A calm and deep pair.
- **Pink**
  Softens the coolness of silver.
- **Black**
  Elegant and firm. Watch the quantity.
- **Gold**
  A festive pair. Beware of too much shine.
- **Brown**
  A warm, earthy impression that grounds silver.

Elements

- **Metal**
  Silver is its natural representative. Watch that it does not dominate.
- **Water**
  Dark blue and black deepen it.
- **Earth**
  Brown and yellow warm it.
- **Wood**
  Green and wood enliven it.

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Feng shui room by room

Living room

What works. A silver frame, candlestick or lamp can add an elegant detail.

What to watch for. When all the mirrors, frames and candlesticks are silver, the room feels cold.

A simple tip. Leave one more striking piece and warmer materials around it.

Kitchen and dining room

What works. Stainless steel and silver details are practical and clean.

What to watch for. Shine shows every fingerprint and limescale.

A simple tip. Choose a matt surface or brushed metal. Add wood and textile.

Bedroom

What works. A soft silver fabric or lamp can give a room a calm impression.

What to watch for. A mirror opposite the bed reflects light and movement and bothers many people.

A simple tip. Try a matt and muted silver. Let the light be warm.

Children's room

What works. A silver star, moon or frame can be play for a child.

What to watch for. A silver wall can turn cold. A child may not want it.

A simple tip. Let the child choose and start with a small detail.

Study

What works. A silver detail on the desk can recall calm and order.

What to watch for. Glossy surfaces around a screen cause reflections.

A simple tip. Leave one accent, mute the rest.

Bathroom

What works. Chrome and silver details give a fresh and clean impression.

What to watch for. Limescale and fingerprints on a glossy surface show more than you imagined.

A simple tip. Consider a matt finish and diffused light.

And try answering now

"Why do I want silver at home? What is it meant to bring me, calm, elegance, or distance?"

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Colour frequency and phototherapy

With silver people speak of “moonlight” and a “pure frequency”. It sounds as if it had its own number that can be read. A silver surface **reflects** light, a silver lamp **emits** light. Let us say which of that is **atmosphere** and which is already **treatment**.

And this is exactly where it is good to put **miraculous promises** aside. A silver wall or a silver filter is not in itself a therapeutic light method.

Silver is not light with a frequency of its own

Silver reflects visible light very well and, according to one review, better than aluminium at longer wavelengths. That is why it is used in mirrors. The silver impression arises from a combination of light grey and shine. The colour of an object, the intensity of the light and the feeling of the surroundings are connected, but they are not interchangeable.

Bacteria and silver

Silver ions disrupt the metabolism of bacteria and silver is used in wound dressings, in some catheters and breathing tubes, and in some textiles and water treatment. That is technology, though, not a colour. **A silver spoon or a silver fabric does not heal.**

Silver and light

Silver halides are sensitive to light and for a long time stood behind film photography. Demand fell with the arrival of digital capture. Silver thus carries light and memory, but not a healing effect.

Moonlight and sleep

Moonlight is soft and faint. If you sleep badly, deal with it with a doctor. Bright-light therapy for seasonal depression uses designated devices and a specific procedure, not the colour silver.

When it is pleasant to switch off the shine

Too many glossy surfaces can dazzle. Some people enjoy shine, others need calm. You do not have to learn to love glitter for your work with colours to be right.

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Astrotype and colours

Are you Libra, Sagittarius or Pisces? The astrotype is a much broader topic than just the sun sign. If you really want to go into **depth**, knowing only your date of birth is not enough. The exact place and time of birth are also important, because only from them are the ascendant, the position of the Moon, planets and other parts of the horoscope calculated. Here, though, we stay only at the edge of what relates to colours.

Astrology does not assign silver unambiguously. It is most often linked with the Moon (cycles, feeling and the reflection of light), sometimes with Mercury (speed and mediation) or Neptune (mist and dream). In alchemy silver is the symbol of the Moon. Sources disagree on this, so take it as inspiration. Depending on how the planet of your sign relates to silver, it may feel close to you or distant. Find your sign (the dates are approximate and vary by year) and read what silver may say to you.

The ascendant is the sign that was rising on the eastern horizon at the moment of your birth. According to astrological tradition it shows how you come across outwardly and how you enter the world, while the Sun sign describes more who you are inside. For each sign you will therefore find not only its character but also a short note on how the colour fits when it is your ascendant.

Aries (21 March – 19 April)

Your silver

silver · red · steel

A silver that **gives you an edge without needless noise**.

Aries is linked with Mars, fire and the start of spring. Silver is for it like a blade, **strength with perspective**. Silver with red may suit you better than a pastel.

What Aries is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality cardinal · ruler Mars

Aries opens the zodiac and you can tell that it is first. It is a **pioneer** who gets into things before thinking them through perfectly. It is direct, impatient and likes to compete. It gets angry quickly but forgives quickly too.

Its strength is the **courage** to begin. Weaker is perseverance in long, slow matters. It does best where something is happening and where it can act at once.

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What it can support in you

Silver can support moments when you want to be decisive and do not want to show off. It suits negotiations, a journey and sport.

With Aries, strength is often in the first step. Silver can add **a cool head**.

Shadow cold as armour

In the shadow Aries wears silver like armour. Coldness poses as control and warmth must not show.

Aries fears that if it showed warmth, it would lose. So it keeps seeming untouchable and never finds out it would have lost less.

The colour can help you here too. It can help you **take one warm thing under the metal** and show it to no one.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mars red or white.

red white brown

Red and white give silver life and clarity.

Aries as ascendant

When Aries is your ascendant, you come across as direct, lively and decisive. People may see you as someone who gets straight to the point, and the first impression tends to be brisk.

Silver gives you calm authority. Steel and mirror are closest.

In everyday life

Take a smooth silver object in your hand and simply hold it for a while.

*When you feel like attacking, have **a silver scarf and five minutes by the window**. You do not have to prove anything.*

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Taurus (20 April – 20 May)

Your silver

pearl · sage · brown

Silver as **velvet, metal and a material with a good finish**.

Taurus is an earth sign linked with Venus, the senses and stability. Silver suits it as a material, not as an idea. Silk, metal and patina are **luxury without shouting**.

What Taurus is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality fixed · ruler Venus

Taurus is an earthy, **patient** and sensual sign. It likes good food, pleasant materials, nature and security. It gets going slowly, but once it decides on something, it persists.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to enjoy the present moment. The weaker side tends to be stubbornness and finding it hard to let go of what is familiar.

What it can support in you

Silver can support the joy of touch and good quality. It suits places where you want comfort and elegance at once.

With Taurus it is often not only about the colour but about the surface. A matt silver and a glossy sheet of metal feel completely different.

Shadow ownership as a mirror

In the shadow Taurus measures itself by what it owns. Silver becomes a mirror in which it sees only possessions.

Taurus likes certainty and silver shows it. Only then nothing new arrives, because everything is covered in shine.

The colour can help you here too. It can help you **give away one teaspoon and not regret it**.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add green and cream.

green · cream · sage

Green and cream give silver freshness and warmth.

Taurus as ascendant

When Taurus is your ascendant, you come across as calm, stable and pleasant. You build trust slowly and people often feel firm ground in you.

Silver gives you a calm and trustworthy impression. Matt suits better than glossy.

In everyday life

Take something silver that you love in your hand and notice how it feels under your fingers.

A silver teaspoon and good tea. ***Treat yourself to them without apology.***

Gemini (21 May – 20 June)

Your silver

mirror · sky blue · yellow

A silver that **lights up your ideas**.

Gemini is an air sign linked with Mercury, curiosity and speech. Silver suits it like quicksilver, which keeps moving. A silver pen, **a silver laptop and a quick message**.

What Gemini is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Gemini is **curious**, talkative and adaptable. It learns quickly, likes to tell stories and enjoys it when a lot is going on around it. It can see several sides of one thing.

Its strength is **lightness** and wit. The weaker side tends to be scatteredness and a tendency to start more things than can be finished.

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What it can support in you

Silver can support moments when you are looking for room for ideas. It suits a diary, a work desk and a bag.

With Gemini, strength is often in ideas and words. Silver can add **focus and depth**.

Shadow a glint instead of content

In the shadow Gemini concentrates on how things look and forgets what they say. Silver becomes a wrapping without content.

Gemini likes to catch attention and silver helps. Only then nobody knows what it actually wanted to say.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **write one sentence without decoration**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mercury yellow or light blue.

yellow | sky blue | white

Yellow and blue add clarity of thought and airiness.

Gemini as ascendant

When Gemini is your ascendant, you come across as lively, friendly and chatty. People may see you as curious and youthful, even if inside you are perhaps calmer.

Silver gives you a lighter and cleaner impression. Mirror and pearl are the lightest.

In everyday life

Take a silver pen and write down three things that caught your interest today.

*When you feel you are playing a role, have **a moment of quiet with a silver sheet of paper**. You do not have to joke about everything.*

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Cancer (21 June – 22 July)

Your silver

pearl · moon · cream

Silver as **the moon above the house**.

Cancer is a water sign linked with the Moon, home and feeling. Silver is its natural colour, like light on water. Pearl and moon can remind you of **a home you return to**.

What Cancer is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality cardinal · ruler Moon

Cancer is **caring**, sensitive and strongly connected to home and family. It has a good memory for feelings and relationships. It enters the world cautiously, much like a crab with its shell.

Its strength is **empathy** and the ability to create safety. The weaker side tends to be changeable moods and a tendency to withdraw when it feels hurt.

What it can support in you

Silver can support moments when you need to calm down. It suits a bedroom, a house and clothing.

With Cancer, strength is often in empathy. Silver can add **permission to be looked after**.

Shadow protection as a mirror

In the shadow Cancer reflects the needs of others and forgets its own. Silver becomes a mirror in which only another person's face can be seen.

Cancers fear rejection and silver gives them a feeling of being “all right”. Then nobody sees that they need something too.

The colour can help you here too. It can help you **say one thing that you need** and leave it at that.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Moon white and cream.

white · cream · rose white

White and cream give silver light and openness.

Cancer as ascendant

When Cancer is your ascendant, you come across as gentle and careful. At first you keep your distance, but then warmth unfolds and people see in you someone who will look after them.

Silver gives you an impression of calm and care. Muted and soft shades suit.

In everyday life

In the evening take a silver spoon or mug in your hand and sit for a while with no tasks.

*When you are tired of keeping watch, have **a silver scarf and remind yourself** that rest belongs to you too.*

Leo (23 July – 22 August)

Your silver

silver · gold · red

A silver that **lets you shine more quietly**.

Leo is a fire sign ruled by the Sun. Silver is for it a counterpart to gold, like the moon beside the sun. A silver dress, a striking lipstick and **calm dignity**.

What Leo is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality fixed · ruler Sun

Leo is **generous**, proud and creative. It likes to give, likes to rejoice and needs others to see and appreciate it. It is loyal and has a big heart.

Its strength is **warmth** and the ability to inspire others. The weaker side tends to be sensitivity to criticism and a tendency to want to be the centre of attention.

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What it can support in you

Silver can support moments when you want to be seen and keep your calm at the same time. It suits an evening, a performance and a celebration.

With Leo, strength is often in creativity and generosity. Silver can add **calm nobility**.

Shadow a second place it cannot bear

In the shadow Leo cannot bear to be second. Silver becomes a medal it does not want to receive.

Leo needs recognition and silver reminds it that it is not first. Then it prefers not to take part.

The colour can help you here too. It can help you **take a silver medal and put it at home in a visible place**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add gold or deep blue.

gold · dark blue · red

Gold and dark blue give silver warmth and depth.

Leo as ascendant

When Leo is your ascendant, you come across as self-assured, warm and striking. You enter a room in a way that people notice you even when you do not want them to.

Silver gives you dignity. Mirror and steel suit better than pearl.

In everyday life

Put on something silver today together with one calm thing.

*When you feel you must shine, take **a silver piece of jewellery and a dark coat**.*

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Virgo (23 August – 22 September)

Your silver

steel · pearl · white

Silver as **clean cutlery and the quiet after tidying up**.

Virgo is an earth sign linked with Mercury, order and care for detail. Silver suits it in clean and precise forms. **A silver pen, a clear desk and a teaspoon** without needless decoration.

What Virgo is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Virgo is **meticulous**, attentive and practical. It notices details that others overlook and likes to be useful. It tends to be modest and judges itself more strictly than others.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to improve things. The weaker side tends to be perfectionism, worries and a tendency to criticise itself.

What it can support in you

Silver can support moments when you want to tidy both the space and your head. It suits a work desk, a wardrobe and a pantry.

With Virgo, strength is often in attention and order. Silver can add **a little forgiveness**.

Shadow polishing without end

In the shadow Virgo polishes until nothing shines. Silver becomes the measure of flawlessness.

Virgo is strict with itself and silver makes that easier. Only joy never arrives.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **leave a fingerprint on one thing**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Mercury grey and green.

grey · green · white

Grey and green add order and calm.

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Virgo as ascendant

When Virgo is your ascendant, you come across as neat, restrained and reliable. People see you as observant and sensible, sometimes even overly reserved.

Silver gives you a delicate and careful impression. Pearl suits better than oxidised.

In everyday life

Put a silver pen or spoon on your desk and correct nothing about it.

*When you feel strict, try **leaving one thing imperfect** and looking at it in warm light.*

Libra (23 September – 22 October)

Your silver

pearl · powder pink · silver

A silver that **suits you in delicacy and style**.

Libra is an air sign ruled by Venus. Silver suits it in elegant and balanced forms. Pearl and powder as **an evening dress with delicate jewellery**.

What Libra is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality cardinal · ruler Venus

Libra longs for **harmony**, beauty and justice. It is diplomatic, sociable and has a feel for aesthetics. It lives best in relationships in which it does not feel alone.

Its strength is **tact** and the ability to see both sides. The weaker side tends to be hesitation and a tendency to avoid conflict even when it would help.

What it can support in you

Silver can support moments when you want beauty and balance without shouting. It suits a flat, clothing and work.

With Libra, strength is often in taste and diplomacy. Silver can add **permission to stay with your own view**.

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Shadow a balance that says nothing

In the shadow Libra keeps everything neutral so as not to hurt anyone. Silver becomes a mirror in which everyone sees only themselves.

Libra wants everything to fit. So it puts its own opinion aside, because it might disturb the whole.

The colour can help you here too. It can help you **write one sentence that you truly think** and let it hang.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Venus green and powder pink.

green · powder pink · white

Green and powder pink add calm and reality.

Libra as ascendant

When Libra is your ascendant, you come across as elegant, pleasant and balanced. People like you for your tact, even if inside you take a long time to decide.

Silver gives you a pleasant and balanced impression. Pearl fits your way of behaving best.

In everyday life

Try a silver scarf or bowl on a table and notice what you like and what you merely do not mind.

*When everything feels too perfect to you, give yourself **one thing in a softer shade** that has a voice of its own.*

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Scorpio (23 October – 21 November)

Your silver

oxidised · wine · black

A silver that **allows you depth without drama**.

Scorpio is a water sign linked with Mars and Pluto, depth and transformation. Silver is for it the night surface of water, **in which something can be left to settle**. Oxidised and wine may be closer to you than pearl.

What Scorpio is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality fixed · ruler Mars, in the newer view also Pluto

Scorpio is **intense**, deep and loyal. It feels strongly, but does not always show it. It dislikes superficiality and likes to get to what is hidden.

Its strength is **determination** and the ability to transform. The weaker side tends to be distrust, jealousy and a need to keep things under control.

What it can support in you

Silver can support moments when you want to be close, but in your own way. It suits a private detail.

With Scorpio, strength is often in depth and loyalty. Silver can add **calm after the storm**.

Shadow a reflection that hides

In the shadow Scorpio shows only a surface that gleams and hides everything else beneath it. Silver becomes a mask.

Scorpios find it hard to open up after being hurt. Silver means for them that nobody sees anything, and yet nobody knows anything.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **take one thing out and put it in the light**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add silver with dark wine.

wine · red · black

Wine and red give silver warmth and depth.

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Scorpio as ascendant

When Scorpio is your ascendant, you come across as focused, mysterious and strong. People sense the intensity of your gaze and often feel that you know more than you say.

Silver gives you calm depth behind a mysterious impression. Oxidised is closest.

In everyday life

Try keeping silver just for yourself, in something nobody sees.

*When you want to withdraw, have **a silver piece of jewellery under your clothes** and let it be your secret.*

Sagittarius (22 November – 21 December)

Your silver

silver · brown · blue

Silver as **a road under the moon**.

Sagittarius is a fire sign linked with Jupiter, freedom and distances. Silver suits it as the colour of an aeroplane and a night journey. Brown and blue as **the road and the sky**.

What Sagittarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter

Sagittarius is **optimistic**, open and free-spirited. It loves travel, new experiences and the search for meaning. It speaks honestly, sometimes a little too directly.

Its strength is **enthusiasm** and faith in a good outcome. The weaker side tends to be impatience with detail and a tendency to promise more than can be managed.

What it can support in you

Silver can support moments when you want to set off but have somewhere to return to. It suits a journey, nature and a café.

With Sagittarius, strength is often in optimism and momentum. Silver can add **awareness of where you set out from**.

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Shadow running from the mirror

In the shadow Sagittarius travels so as not to have to look at itself. Silver becomes an aeroplane that never lands.

Sagittarians love freedom and silver promises them that everything is only a reflection. Only then nobody knows what they wanted.

The colour can help you here too. It can help you **stay home one evening with one mirror**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Jupiter blue or gold.

blue · gold · green

Blue and gold give silver reach and momentum.

Sagittarius as ascendant

When Sagittarius is your ascendant, you come across as open, jovial and adventurous. People see you as someone with a wide outlook and an appetite for discovery.

Silver gives you a friendly and open impression. Silver and brown suit better than oxidised.

In everyday life

Take a silver scarf or coin on a journey and put it back in the same place when you return.

*When something feels tight, try **looking to see whether it is only closeness**.*

Capricorn (22 December – 19 January)

Your silver

steel · anthracite · brown

A silver that **allows you to be firm and calm**.

Capricorn is an earth sign linked with Saturn, responsibility and perseverance. Silver suits it in muted forms, like **an honour after long work**. Steel and anthracite add a maturity that can warm.

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What Capricorn is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality cardinal · ruler Saturn

Capricorn is **responsible**, goal-oriented and disciplined. It likes to build and is not afraid of a long road. It has a dry sense of humour and shows it only to those it trusts.

Its strength is **perseverance** and the ability to see things through. The weaker side tends to be strictness with itself, reserve and a tendency to put joy off until later.

What it can support in you

Silver can support moments when you want to lay a firm foundation. It suits an office, negotiations and long-term plans.

With Capricorn, strength is often in order and perseverance. Steel can add **willingness to rest**.

Shadow a coldness that poses as responsibility

In the shadow Capricorn wears silver as the uniform of duty. Warmth is put off until later.

Capricorn fears that if it rested, it would achieve nothing. Then even the shine is just another task.

The colour can help you here too. It can help you **find one place where nothing gets improved**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add Saturn grey and cream.

slate · cream · brown

Grey and cream give silver weight and warmth.

Capricorn as ascendant

When Capricorn is your ascendant, you come across as serious, mature and reserved. People may see you as older than you are, and only later discover how funny you are.

Silver gives you a trustworthy and calm impression. Steel works best.

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In everyday life

Put a silver button or cuff on a serious outfit.

*When you are too strict, try to **look at a silver thing and improve nothing**.*

Aquarius (20 January – 18 February)

Your silver

mirror · sky blue · silver

Silver as **an unexpected idea** among colours.

Aquarius is an air sign linked with Saturn and Uranus, independence and ideas. Silver belongs to it as an inconspicuous choice that surprises. Mirror next to sky looks like **the colour of a calm future**.

What Aquarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality fixed · ruler Saturn, in the newer view also Uranus

Aquarius is **independent**, original and idealistic. It is interested in ideas, humanity and the future. It wants to go its own way and does not like adapting to expectations.

Its strength is **perspective** and the ability to come up with new things. The weaker side tends to be distance from feelings and a tendency to withdraw when there is too much closeness.

What it can support in you

Silver can support moments when you want something unusual, but with calm. It suits a poster, a logo and clothing.

With Aquarius, strength is often in originality and perspective. Silver can add **firm ground under ideas**.

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Shadow distance as identity

In the shadow Aquarius defines itself by belonging nowhere. Silver becomes a stance against everyone.

Aquarians like to keep their perspective and silver makes that easier. Only then the body waits for a touch that does not come.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **take something rough and natural in your hand** and just notice it for a while.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add cool blue or white.

sky blue · white · silver

Blue and white give silver purity and distance.

Aquarius as ascendant

When Aquarius is your ascendant, you come across as independent, a little unusual and friendly. People see you as an original personality who keeps their own space.

Silver gives you an unexpected and friendly impression. Mirror and sky are closest.

In everyday life

Try keeping one silver thing in your bag for a week and explain it to nobody.

*When everything seems too neutral to you, try **telling yourself what you like about it**.*

Pisces (19 February – 20 March)

Your silver

moon · lavender · sky blue

Silver as **moonlight on water**.

Pisces is a water sign linked with Jupiter and Neptune, feeling and imagination. Silver can give it calm and lightness. Moon and lavender may remind you of **mist over the sea**.

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What Pisces is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter, in the newer view also Neptune

Pisces is **empathic**, intuitive and dreamy. It picks up the moods around it and often has a rich imagination. It frequently has a bond with art, music and spirituality.

Its strength is **compassion** and creative fantasy. The weaker side tends to be merging with other people's feelings, escaping into dreams and difficulty setting boundaries.

What it can support in you

Silver can support moments when you need to anchor yourself. It suits a bedroom, a painting and a scent.

With Pisces, strength is often in empathy and imagination. Silver can add **willingness to stand firm even in the current**.

Shadow a reflection without a face of its own

In the shadow Pisces dissolves in the reflection and cannot tell what is its own and what is someone else's. Silver becomes a veil.

Pisces is sensitive and easily takes on other people's atmosphere. Silver gives it comfort, but not direction.

The colour can also help you here. It helps you **have one thing at home that you chose yourself**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Add silver with blue or green.

blue · green · cream

Blue and green give silver water and earth.

Pisces as ascendant

When Pisces is your ascendant, you come across as gentle, dreamy and adaptable. People like to project their wishes onto you and tend to be kind to you.

Silver gives you a soft and calm impression. Moon and lavender are closest.

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In everyday life

In the evening light a candle, take a silver object in your hand and write three sentences about the day.

When you feel like running away, hold ***a silver thing firmly in your hand*** *and come back into the room.*

FOR A DEEPER LOOK

Seasons

Silver is the colour of winter, mist and autumn evenings. Summer leaves it mostly to the night, when the moon shines. Ask yourself when you reach for it.

Time of day

Dusk and night belong to silver most. Morning gives it a cool note and noon shows its shine too sharply.

Years of life

Saturn orbits the Sun in roughly 29 years. Astrology speaks of its returns at roughly 29 and 58 years and reads them as times when a person asks what is really theirs. In those years silver may feel close to you as a calm you have earned, or, on the contrary, foreign, as a colour someone assigned to you. Both are natural. Research by Palmer and Schloss (2010) also reports that we like colours according to the things and experiences we associate with them. Astrology does not rule this out, it just offers another view.

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Colour for your website and business

Yes, above all where you sell purity, precision and a modern impression. Silver promises calm, but it can easily seem cold.

In business silver is a colour that **invites trust in precision**, but it also carries the label of distance. It can seem modern, technical, elegant and luxurious. That is why it is good to know what you are promising before you let it into a logo, a website or an advertisement.

By itself, though, it **does not attract customers** like a magnet. It can help create **a striking impression**, but what still decides is mainly **what you sell**, **to whom** and **how well** it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Silver can say, for example

“*It is precise.*” “*It is modern.*” “*It is clean.*” “*It is calm.*”

- **Elegance and craft.** Silver is often used for cutlery, jewellery and design.
- **Technology.** Metal, stainless steel and silver belong to technology. Too much, however, can feel sterile.
- **Prestige.** Second place, a medal, cards. Silver here tends to be a step below gold.
- **Coldness.** Without a warm companion it can seem aloof.
- **Mirror.** A gleam catches the eye. It must not dazzle.

Depending on the shade, though, it also acts differently. Pearl is **delicate and modern**, steel **firm and technical**, oxidised **traditional and earthy**.

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Simple tips

Add warmth
Wood, photographs of people or a gentle colour companion. Pure silver alone tends to be cold.

Show the product
A silver package on a silver background disappears. Give it contrast.

Shade by role
Steel for technology, pearl for delicacy, oxidised for tradition.

Legibility
Silver text on a light background is hard to read. Watch the size and contrast.

A human face
Precision does not have to stand in the doorway with arms folded. Add clear language.

Colour blindness
About 1 in 12 men has trouble telling red and green apart. Dark text on a light background is the safest choice for most people.

Professions where it is a Yes

The rule is simple. When you sell precision, purity or a modern impression, silver can help you.

Jewellery, cutlery and design

Silver here belongs to both material and colour. Make sure the shine does not say more than the product itself.

Technology and vehicles

Metal and silver here give an impression of a new era. Make sure it does not seem sterile.

Clinical and laboratory settings

Silver can support an impression of cleanliness and precision. Add personal touches so the place does not recall a factory.

Fashion and art

Silver suits an evening, a campaign and a stage. Wood and a gentle companion calm it down.

Professions where it is a No

This is not a ban for whole fields. What decides is the interplay of colour, text, photographs and setting.

- **Care for people.** Too much coldness can seem unapproachable.
- **Playful and light services.** For services promising lightness and play, silver can create different expectations.
- **Clinics and counselling.** Coldness can clash with confidentiality.
- **Long texts on a website.** Silver text on a light background is tiring.
- **Product presentations.** A silver filter can distort the real colours.

Most important is not whether a design looks expensive. It is whether a person understands where they have come and what they can expect.

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Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer and ask “What would you expect from such a place or service?” **Is the offer visible, or mainly the silver?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that silver means a modern style.

A question for you

“What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?”

Examples from the market

You know silver from cutlery, jewellery and racing cars. Here are **a few examples** that show what it can do.

- **Rolls-Royce Silver Ghost (cars)**
  In 1907 Claude Johnson had a demonstration car made for Rolls-Royce, painted in aluminium paint, with silver-plated fittings. The name Silver Ghost was meant to stress its almost silent running.
- **Georg Jensen (silversmithing)**
  The Danish silversmith Georg Jensen opened his own workshop in Copenhagen in 1904. His Art Nouveau designs often used organic shapes and precious stones such as amber or opal.
- **Christofle (cutlery)**
  The brand was founded in Paris in 1830 by Charles Christofle. In 1842 he obtained patents for electroplated gilding and silvering, bringing silver plating to France.
- **Mercedes-Benz (cars)**
  The Mercedes teams are nicknamed the Silver Arrows, in German Silberpfeile. In the 1930s, together with Auto Union, they dominated racing. The nickname has stayed to this day.

What they share is that silver carries a simple message. **Precision and distance.** And it mostly does not outweigh what is around it.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, on customers and on how consistent the brand is. Take it as an idea to test, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

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Different colour combinations

Silver + red

How it feels

Elegance and fire. Red warms silver and silver gives red distance. Together they feel festive and modern.

When it suits

When you want **expression and perspective**.

Specific shades


silver + red
boldly


steel + wine
festively


pearl + coral
dramatically


mirror + scarlet
modernly


oxidised + brick
muted

In practice

A red dress and silver jewellery. A red wall and a silver frame.

Watch out

Two strong colours tend to be loud. Add **white or black**.

Silver + orange

How it feels

Sunset and moon. Orange warms silver and silver calms orange. Together they feel unusual and playful.

When it suits

When you want **warmth and distance**.

Specific shades


silver + orange
radiantly


steel + terracotta
freshly


pearl + apricot
playfully


mirror + pumpkin
daringly


oxidised + rust
earthily

In practice

An orange jumper and silver jewellery. An orange cushion and a silver lamp.

Watch out

Too much orange next to silver shouts. Try to **mute it with something earthier**.

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Silver + yellow

How it feels

Sun and moon. Yellow lights silver up and silver gives yellow calm. Together they feel joyful and clean.

When it suits

When you want **lightness and light**.

Specific shades



silver + yellow
cheerfully



steel + ochre
freshly



pearl + buttery
brightly



mirror + lemon
radiantly



oxidised + mustard
muted

In practice

A yellow scarf and silver jewellery. A yellow wall and a silver frame.

Watch out

At equal intensity the colours pull against each other. Leave yellow **as an accent**.

Silver + green

How it feels

Dew. Green revives silver and silver gives green a gleam. Together they feel fresh and natural.

When it suits

When you want **a fresh and lively impression**.

Specific shades



silver + green
naturally



steel + bottle green
freshly



pearl + mint
lightly



mirror + emerald
strikingly



oxidised + sage
quietly

In practice

A green plant in a silver pot. Sage and silver in the kitchen.

Watch out

A sharp green next to silver sounds loud. **Mute** the green.

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Silver + blue

How it feels

Water and moon. Blue cools silver and silver brightens blue. Together they feel calm and airy.

When it suits

When you want **calm and depth**.

Specific shades



silver + blue
calmly



steel + dark blue
airily



pearl + sky blue
freshly



mirror + cobalt
nautically



oxidised + denim
soberly

In practice

A blue dress and silver jewellery. A pale blue wall and silver frames.

Watch out

Both tend to be cool. Without warmth the whole can seem **cold**.

Silver + indigo

How it feels

Night sky. Indigo deepens silver and silver gives indigo light. Together they look like stars.

When it suits

When you want **depth without heaviness**.

Specific shades



silver + indigo
at dusk



steel + ink
deeply



pearl + twilight blue
firmly



mirror + ultramarine
festively



oxidised + grey indigo
soberly

In practice

An indigo coat and silver buttons. Dark blue and silver in an office.

Watch out

Dark and glossy can feel sharp. Add **cream**.

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Silver + violet

How it feels

Lavender. Purple softens silver and silver gives purple lightness. Together they feel dreamy and elegant.

When it suits

When you want **delicacy and a sense of something beyond**.

Specific shades


silver + purple
dreamily


steel + plum
gently


pearl + lavender
mysteriously


mirror + orchid
richly


oxidised + grey purple
dustily

In practice

Lavender and silver in a dress. A purple piece of jewellery and a silver clasp.

Watch out

Too much purple and silver can seem cold. Add **a warmer shade**.

Silver + pink

How it feels

Freshness. Pink softens silver and silver gives pink a modern feel. Together they feel fresh and tender.

When it suits

When you want **tenderness without sweetness**.

Specific shades


silver + pink
tenderly


steel + raspberry
gently


pearl + powder
freshly


mirror + fuchsia
modernly


oxidised + old rose
unobtrusively

In practice

A pink blouse and silver jewellery. A pink wall and a silver frame.

Watch out

Two sweet colours tend to be too sweet. Add **green or grey**.

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Silver + brown

How it feels

Earth and moon. Brown warms silver and silver brightens brown. Together they feel natural and calm.

When it suits

When you want **warmth and support**.

Specific shades



silver + brown
naturally



steel + chocolate
cosily



pearl + beige
soberly



mirror + caramel
earthily



oxidised + linen
unobtrusively

In practice

A brown coat and silver jewellery. A wooden table and a silver lamp.

Watch out

Two muted colours tend to be heavy. Add **white or cream**.

Silver + white

How it feels

Snow and ice. White brightens silver and silver gives white a gleam. Together they feel clean and light.

When it suits

When you want **purity and lightness**.

Specific shades



silver + white
cleanly



steel + ivory
lightly



pearl + snow
gently



mirror + milk
radiantly



oxidised + bone
muted

In practice

A white shirt and silver jewellery. White ceramics with a silver rim.

Watch out

Both tend to be cool. Add **wood or linen**.

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Silver + black

How it feels

Evening. Black sets silver off and silver gives black a gleam. Together they feel elegant and modern.

When it suits

When you want **elegance with depth**.

Specific shades



silver + black
elegantly



steel + charcoal
modernly



pearl + anthracite
dramatically



mirror + ink black
radiantly



oxidised + soot
muted

In practice

A black dress and silver jewellery. Black packaging with silver lettering.

Watch out

In excess it feels cold. Add **one calm surface**.

Silver + gold

How it feels

Sun and moon. Gold warms silver and silver gives gold calm. Together they feel festive and balanced.

When it suits

When you want **celebration without heaviness**.

Specific shades



silver + gold
festively



steel + antique gold
richly



pearl + champagne
gently



mirror + deep gold
radiantly



oxidised + matt gold
muted

In practice

Gold and silver jewellery together. A silver frame with a gold detail.

Watch out

In an excess of shine it looks like a shop window. Add **a matt companion**.

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A SIMPLE RULE

- When you want to **soften** silver, add **pink**, **cream**, **wood** or **linen**.
- When you want to **enliven** it, add **green**, **yellow** or **gold**.
- When you want to **deepen** it, **indigo**, **dark blue** or **brown** will help.
- When you want to **make it stand out**, add **black**, **white** or **red**.

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